



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Berean Christian High School
School Website: <https://www.bereanchristian.com/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL**Classicality Audit Report: Austin Classical School**

Website audited: <https://austinclassical.org>

Executive Summary

Overall classification: CLASSICAL

Why: Austin Classical School explicitly frames its aim as the cultivation of “wisdom and virtue” through a “classical, Christian education,” anchored in the contemplation of “Truth, Goodness, and Beauty,” and employing the Trivium with stage-appropriate pedagogy (memorization/recitation/songs in the lower grades; debate/discussion in logic; rhetoric in upper grades). These statements and practices strongly align with the Six Essential Elements framework and keyword indicators for classical schools. Evidence for faculty formation/portrait and robust parent formation is thinner in the crawl sample, but there is clear language about “co-laboring with families,” which supports classical parent partnership.

Method note: Scoring and keyword checks are benchmarked against the Positive/Negative Keyword Indicators in the Six Essential Elements reference set and the classicality lexicon (truth, goodness, beauty; liberal arts; Trivium/Quadrivium; Great Books; Socratic; scholé; wonder; chanting; project-based/experiential learning, etc.)

CATEGORY 1: RELIGIOUS AND METAPHYSICAL FOUNDATIONS**1) Keywords/phrases found on the school site**

- “exists to glorify Jesus Christ” (theological telos)
- “classical, Christian education” (faith and reason frame)
- “Truth, Goodness, and Beauty” (transcendentals)
- “wisdom,” “virtue” (moral realism/formation language)

2) Comparison to Six Elements keyword lists

- Positive indicators matched: theology/Christ-centered (“glorify Jesus Christ”); transcendental moral realism (truth/goodness/beauty); virtue/wisdom formation. These map to the “Transcendental and Moral Realism,” “Grounded in Theology,” and “Liturgical/Communal” families of keywords (the latter not explicitly evidenced liturgically).
- Negative indicators: none detected (no “values-neutral” or relativist language).

3) Quantitative keyword tally

- Positive hits: +5 (glorify Jesus Christ; Christian; truth; goodness; beauty)
- Negative hits: -0
- Percent positive: 1.00
- Coverage estimate: 0.70 (strong transcendental/theological language; no explicit chapel/liturgy statements in the crawl)

4) Category rating: CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 2: SCHOOL PURPOSE AND GOAL

1) Keywords/phrases found

- “To cultivate wisdom and virtue...” (stated Aim)
- “contemplation of the True, the Good, and the Beautiful” (stated Method)
- “great ideas,” “great books,” “great conversation” (ends directed to wisdom)

2) Comparison to Six Elements keyword lists

- Positive indicators matched: formation over information (cultivation of virtue/wisdom), pursuit of truth/-goodness/beauty, great conversation—exact matches to the “Purpose and Goal” set.
- Negative indicators: none (no “college and career readiness/21st-century skills” framing).

3) Quantitative keyword tally

- Positive hits: +6 (wisdom; virtue; truth; goodness; beauty; great conversation)
- Negative hits: -0
- Percent positive: 1.00
- Coverage estimate: 1.00 (explicit Aim/Method statements align fully)

4) Category rating: CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 3: SCHOOL CURRICULUM

1) Keywords/phrases found

- “The Trivium... Grammar, Logic, and Rhetoric” (Seven Liberal Arts—Trivium)
- “classical books,” “great books,” “great conversation” (Great Books)
- “integrated curriculum” (integration/harmony of subjects)
- “art and music” (Quadrivial resonance with music)

2) Comparison to Six Elements keyword lists

- Positive indicators matched: Trivium; Great Books and Great Conversation; integrated approach; beauty in learning.
- Negative indicators: no “social studies” replacing history; no STEM-first/career-prep emphasis; no “project-based learning” dominance.

3) Quantitative keyword tally

- Positive hits: +6 (Trivium; Grammar; Logic; Rhetoric; Great Books; integrated)
- Negative hits: -0
- Percent positive: 1.00
- Coverage estimate: 0.85 (explicit Trivium/Great Books/integration; not all Quadrivium elements named)

4) Category rating: CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 4: SCHOOL PEDAGOGY (TEACHING METHODS)

1) Keywords/phrases found

- “memorization, recitation, and songs” in Grammar stage (chanting/singing/recitation)
 - “debate and discussion” in Logic stage (Socratic/dialectic)
 - “Rhetoric stage (Grades 9–12)” (rhetoric emphasis)
- 2) Comparison to Six Elements keyword lists
- Positive indicators matched: memorization/recitation/chanting; Socratic discussion/debate; rhetoric/oratory trajectory—core classical pedagogy. The “scholé/restful” language is not explicit in the crawl.
 - Negative indicators: no constructivist/experiential□only or project□only framing detected.
- 3) Quantitative keyword tally
- Positive hits: +4 (memorization; recitation; songs; debate/discussion)
 - Negative hits: –0
 - Percent positive: 1.00
 - Coverage estimate: 0.80 (strong K–8 and logic/rhetoric signals; no explicit “scholé”)
- 4) Category rating: CLASSICAL
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CATEGORY 5: SCHOOL FACULTY

- 1) Keywords/phrases found
- Crawl references an Employment page listing qualifications; no explicit “portrait of a teacher,” “faculty of friends,” or “living curriculum” language detected in the sample.
- 2) Comparison to Six Elements keyword lists
- Positive indicators sought but not detected in crawl: teachers as models/mentors, collegiality, faculty formation in classical pedagogy.
 - Negative indicators: none explicit (no “teacher as facilitator/guide on the side” jargon in the sample).
- 3) Quantitative keyword tally
- Positive hits: +0
 - Negative hits: –0
 - Percent positive: 0.00
 - Coverage estimate: 0.10 (insufficient public wording in crawl about faculty formation/portrait)
- 4) Category rating: NOT CLASSICAL (insufficient evidence in this crawl segment to confirm classical faculty formation language)
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CATEGORY 6: PARENTS AND COMMUNITY

- 1) Keywords/phrases found
- “co□laboring with families” (parent partnership)
- 2) Comparison to Six Elements keyword lists
- Positive indicators matched: partnership with parents/co□educators. No explicit evidence of parent formation events/book studies or open□campus practices in the crawl excerpt.
 - Negative indicators: none detected.
- 3) Quantitative keyword tally
- Positive hits: +1 (parent partnership)
 - Negative hits: –0

- Percent positive: 1.00
- Coverage estimate: 0.40 (clear partnership claim; limited detail on parent formation)

4) Category rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Aggregate Judgment

- Category ratings: [C1 CLASSICAL; C2 CLASSICAL; C3 CLASSICAL; C4 CLASSICAL; C5 NOT CLASSICAL; C6 SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL]
- Overall classification: CLASSICAL (most criteria met with strong textual alignment to classical aims and methods)

Notes on keyword presence/absence - Present: truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; wisdom; Trivium; Great Books; great conversation; memorization; recitation; singing; debate; discussion; Christian framing. - Not detected in crawl: scholé/restful learning; explicit chapel/liturgy; chanting as a term (songs/recitation present); explicit “Socratic seminar” phrase (debate/discussion present); negative signals like “project-based learning dominance” or “experiential learning focus.”

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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